Subject:	BUM1781
Assessment:	Assignment 1 30 % Weight
Due date:	2026-09-05
Total:	50 Marks

Business Management 1781 – Assignment

Entrepreneurship encompasses the pursuit of opportunities through innovation, resource allocation, and risk-taking to create and grow successful ventures. It involves identifying market gaps, developing unique ideas, and taking calculated risks to bring those ideas to life.

Entrepreneurs are driven by a passion for their vision and possess a strong sense of initiative and resilience, as well as the diligence to pursue it.

On the other hand, business management refers to the organisation and coordination of resources, processes, and people within a company to achieve its objectives. It involves planning, decision-making, organising, leading, and controlling various aspects of a business, such as operations, finance, marketing, and human resources, to ensure its smooth functioning and long-term success.

OBJECTIVE OF THIS ASSIGNMENT

The objective of this assignment is to research and analyse the mission statement of Checkers SA and specific new ventures that this business embarked on; also, the long-term strategies The aim is for you to gain insights into their growth, their CSR/CSI programmes, and long-term innovation. In addition to its overall brand strength, Checkers has secured the top spot as South Africa's leading retail brand.

In 2020, Shoprite and Checkers, which were well entrenched as South Africa's low-price leaders at that time, saved consumers millions because of the millions of customers that have joined the Xtra Saving rewards programme to receive instant cash savings at the till rather than complicated point accumulation or tier levels. This program was expanded to Shoprite supermarkets in October 2020, following its successful initial launch by Checker in 2019.

Key Program Features
- cross-brand usage
- personalised deals: tailored promotions based on actual shopping habits and preferences
- instant till-slip savings clearly itemised on the receipt
- no points or tiers, immediate cash discounts

This was in line with its long-term strategy to provide affordable products and was evident

in its continued market share gains during the Coronavirus pandemic, when customers were under unprecedented financial pressure.

The Group's focus on its customers was built on the back of affordability and addressing customer needs, and this remains a key differentiator of its business.
Note: In October 2020, this program saved consumers R333 million.

Question 1: CSR versus CSI versus Goodwill

The 'R5 meals' were introduced to ensure that customers could get a hot meal from a Shoprite deli, or even for less. They also subsidised their 600g in-house bakery bread, which has remained at R4.99 since April 2016, when the retailer first started its bread subsidy.
The Group's scale and operational efficiency are critical to its low-price leadership strategy and its ability to retain its competitive position on affordability.
It also continues to innovate to bring the lowest prices to customers. This has included the launch of the Usave eKasi mobile trucks to ensure customers in hard-to-reach areas were able to get access to food.

1.1 Are these examples of CSR or CSI? Elaborate on your answer to give the examiner a very clear and logical explanation in business terms. Ensure that you distinguish between 'responsibility' and 'investment'. **[3]**

1.2 Explain to the examiner one way in which a business can show goodwill to its *employees.* You do not have to focus on Checkers SA in your answer. **[1]**

1.3 Explain to the examiner two ways in which a business can show goodwill to its *customers.* Write the explanations in your own words and ensure that all new terminology is explained to the examiner. You do not have to focus on Checkers SA in your answer. **[2]**

Question 2: The mission of Checkers SA

Today, the Checkers brand is defined by convenience, quality and freshness. The brand has grown its share of the mid-to-upper segment of the market by introducing the FreshX concept and adjacent offerings, such as PetShop Science and Little Me, as well as on-demand delivery through Sixty60 and unique product partnerships.

Broader corporate mission: 'To uplift lives every day by pioneering access to the most affordable goods and services, creating economic opportunity and protecting our planet.'

Subject:	BUM1781
Assessment:	Assignment 1 30 % Weight
Due date:	2026-09-05
Total:	50 Marks

2.1 Explain the FreshX concept idea by discussing the following elements: **[2]**

- concept of **convenience** [1]
- concept of a tailor-made element contributing to an **upmarket/premium shopping feeling** [1]

2.2 Give two examples of how ***interactive*** elements have been incorporated to encourage customer engagement**.** **[2]**

2.3 *Explain* one product of Checkers SA that is being *sourced ethically* to protect our planet. **[2]**

2.4 Ethical Practices **[6]**

What does it mean to source from an ethical supply chain and focus on sustainability across operations? Ensure that you give a full explanation to the examiner. **[3 x 2 = 6]**

2.5 Explain the concept of a high-end product in general, not only focusing on products in Checkers retail, but globally. Ensure that you give the examiner a minimum of 3 elements/features of such products in your explanation. **[3]**

NOTE: *Do not give product examples such as Ferrari cars.*

NOTE: Do not explain or list the following features namely: expensive products nor highest quality in the range of products.

2.6 List 2 examples of high-end quality products you can buy in Checkers. Write your answer in full. **[2]**

NOTE: Examiner's example: Forage & Feast gourmet products such as vinegar from Italian Prosecco.

2.7 What is an affluent customer? **[2]**

NOTE: They are often considered a lucrative target market for brands due to their willingness to spend and their appreciation for quality and exclusivity.

2.8 Do you believe that the ***Sixty60 on-demand delivery service*** focuses on this market? **[2]**

Yes – explain your stance to the examiner by applying 2 elements that will support your stance from the research you have done.
OR
No- explain your stance to the examiner by applying 2 elements that will support your stance from the research you have done.

Question 3: Services provided by Checkers, powered by the Shoprite Group

3.1 Checkers offers a variety of accessible financial services in-store and online within its retail setting. A one-stop service point for transactions. **[1]**
List one financial service and explain your listed example to the examiner.

NOTE: Do not list a service provided by the 'Money Market Account' option.
Examiner's Example: Financial service - Voucher purchases. Checkers customers can purchase gift cards and savings stamps.

3.2 Checkers stores offer various in-house service departments or markets, including bakeries, for example. **[2]**

List 2 examples of in-house markets for a discerning, affluent customer base, where the focus is on convenience ***as well as*** to give Checkers a competitive edge.

NOTE: Examiner's Example: the fresh in-house Bakery is for convenience. Still, it doesn't really give Checkers a competitive edge, as PnP, Spar and Woolworths in affluent customer areas also have in-house Bakeries.

3.3 Today, Checkers officially operates one standalone format tailored for Food, combined with their traditional models. They *boast 4 store formats* and an award-winning grocery delivery service.

Is the FrexhX store format in competition with the Woolworths convenience store formats?
a) Yes or No **[2]**

b) What is the latest business entrepreneurial move of Woolworths to gain a bigger customer segment in South Africa? Focus in your research and answer on a new store format that Woolworth has introduced. **[2]**

Question 4: The Shoprite Group's purpose

To uplift lives every day by pioneering access to the most affordable goods and services, creating economic opportunity, and protecting our planet. They drive innovation in products and services and ensure the sustainability of their business.

Module 3 briefly introduces the Triple Bottom Line approach in business, namely: Profit, People and the Planet (PPP). A company's performance should be measured equally on social issues, environmental goals, and corporate profits.

4.1 How is Checkers SA contributing to planetary well-being? Discuss **in full** an example of each category on how this company is taking initiatives and planning new strategies. **[9]**

i) Renewable Energy initiative **[2]**

ii) Recyclable or Biodegradable Packaging initiative of *products on the shelves* **[2]**

iii) Planet Bag initiative **AND** how customers are incentivised to reuse them and earn discounts **[3]**

iv) Explain one initiative of Sixty60 on-demand delivery service, which focuses on corporate social responsibility **(CSR):** could be the transport mode, the packaging, the technology used, et cetera. Your explanation focuses only on **ONE** initiative/element and ensures that your explanation to the examiner is structured, detailed and logical. **[2]**

Question 5: Seth Godin - "Marketing is no longer about the stuff you make, but the stories you tell." Customers don't buy a product; they buy a story. And when done right, people believe them. Godin argues that a marketer's job is to make change happen, and that embracing this idea rather than hiding from it is paramount.

Do research on the story of the Checkers Sixty60 venture in South Africa (briefly, how the idea started and the venture became a reality).

5.1 What was done correctly, and still is, the key factors driving its dominance. Briefly discuss 2 factors. **[2]**

5.2 In the beginning years, the Sixty60 venture didn't show profits. Why would a business continue to spend millions on marketing for a specific business venture that is not showing profits? **[2]**

5.3 Where do you think Checkers Holdings puts its fear when they leap to innovate? **[2]**
Remember that entrepreneurs and businesses do not gamble; they only take calculated risks.
The risks taken to open store formats for the affluent customer. Where did this business put its fear? Or the risks taken to start an on-demand delivery service, for example.

This is a question where the examiner will look at the critical thinking in your answer.

Subject:	BUM1781
Assessment:	Assignment 1 30 % Weight
Due date:	2026-09-05
Total:	50 Marks

INSTRUCTIONS

THIS ASSIGNMENT WILL BE INCLUDED IN THE OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS OF THE UPCOMING EXAM PAPER IN NOVEMBER 2026. PLEASE ENSURE THAT YOU DO IN-DEPTH RESEARCH.

GROUP MEMBERS HAVE TO WORK TOGETHER. FOCUS ON SYNERGY.

A MEMORANDUM WILL BE UPLOADED ON BC CONNECT WHEN THE MARKING IS DONE.

1. This is a Group Assignment of 3 to 6 members.

2. If any Group experiences issues/concerns with a team member not participating 100 % and not pulling his/her weight, please email Mrs C. Boshoff immediately.

3. Please ensure that *every team member* submits a Word document for the assignment, not only the group coordinator. Please do not submit a PDF File.

4. Cover Page: Only include the Subject information and details for each team member. Please indicate who the coordinator for the Group is.

5. YOU WILL RECEIVE A ZERO-MARK ALLOCATION IF THE ASSIGNMENT IS SUBMITTED LATE PER INDIVIDUAL.

YOU WILL RECEIVE A ZERO-MARK ALLOCATION IF YOU DIDN'T SUBMIT AT ALL.

YOU WILL NOT RECEIVE A PERCENTAGE OF THE GROUP MARK FOR WORK DONE BY YOU, NOR A PERCENTAGE PENALTY.
THE PENALTY IS 0 %.

6. You will receive a zero-mark allocation for a question if you copied any answers from AI such as ChatGPT. You will also face a disciplinary hearing.

7. A Table of Contents is not required.

8. Due Date as communicated in the Study Guide and in the Instructions:
5 September 2026. Please adhere to the time scheduled for the submission deadline.

9. Please work together in a shared document and ensure that your contribution is submitted not later than FRIDAY, 04 JULY 2026, to the student who is compiling the document. It will allow all students to read through the document on the 5th and to submit in time.

10. Each team member must submit a minimum of two references to the 'shared document'. **[1]**

Subject:	BUM1781
Assessment:	Assignment 1 30 % Weight
Due date:	2026-09-05
Total:	50 Marks

The Reference List must be on a separate page.
Please adhere to the Harvard Reference guidelines. Use MS Word for the Referencing.

11. Formatting: Calibre size 11 or 12

12. Formatting: Line spacing – 1.5

NOTE: The weight of the Assignment is 30 % of your final mark.

NOTE: Students who compile the document will receive an additional 5 % added to their mark.